

MARLON DE PAZ

AI Infrastructure & Governance Architect

CCIE · CKA · NVIDIA AIOps · IEEE & Springer Author · Isovalent 20x

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior AI Infrastructure & Network Architect with 13+ years of global ICT experience, currently architecting sovereign AI cloud infrastructure at Core42 (G42 Group) in Abu Dhabi. IEEE-published researcher, CCIE, CKA, NVIDIA AIOps Associate, and Isovalent 20x Lab Champion with rare full-stack mastery spanning eBPF kernel networking, Kubernetes orchestration, Cloud operations, and large-scale data center automation. Proven track record delivering enterprise-grade solutions for Nokia, Citi Bank, Cisco, and critical UAE national AI/Cloud infrastructure. Trilingual (English, Portuguese, Spanish). Actively pursuing CCIE Automation, ISO/IEC 42001 Lead Implementer, and Claude Certified Architect credentials to bridge AI infrastructure expertise with AI governance and application architecture.

PUBLICATIONS

- Kubernetes-Aware Load Balancing for Leaf-Spine EVPN Data Centers**
Journal of Cloud Computing · Springer Nature · 2025 · [link.springer.com/article/10.1186/s13677-025-00814-0](#)
- Decentralized and Dynamic Zero-Touch Provisioning of Leaf-Spine EVPN Data Centers**
IEEE Xplore · [ieeexplore.ieee.org/document/11080420](#)

CORE TECHNICAL DOMAINS

AI / HPC GPU Fabric InfiniBand · RDMA · RoCEv2 · NVLink · NVSwitch · GPUDirect · NVIDIA UFM · OFED · GPU Clusters	Network Architecture IP/MPLS · SR-MPLS · EVPN · VXLAN · BGP · Subnet Manager (OpenSM) · ECN/DCQCN · PFC · QoS
Automation & Agentic Systems Ansible · Terraform · Python · REST APIs · Event-Driven Automation · LLM / Agentic Pipelines · NetBox	Cloud & Containers Kubernetes · OpenStack · Prometheus · Grafana · Loki · Zabbix
Security & Compliance NIST CSF · AAA/TACACS+/RADIUS · Red Hat IDM · Secure-by-Design · IAM	AI Governance (In Progress) ISO/IEC 42001 · NIST AI RMF · Responsible AI · Risk Assessment · AIMS

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Network Architect — IP/MPLS Technology

Core42 (G42 Group) · Abu Dhabi, UAE · Dec 2024 – Present

Architecting sovereign AI cloud network infrastructure for the UAE's national AI platform — one of the largest AI compute environments outside the United States.

- Define and own end-to-end Data Center Interconnect (DCI) architecture using IP/MPLS Core, SR-MPLS, SR Traffic Engineering, TI-LFA, BGP-PIC, following IETF/RFC 9014 standards for secure multi-site EVPN at hyperscale
- Created the weekly IP Core capacity consumption report combining a deterministic pipeline with an agentic AI approach for automated analysis and narrative generation
- Built a framework to parse all cloud circuits into NetBox using Ansible and REST APIs, ensuring flawless source-of-truth integration across the estate
- Developed custom Zabbix templates for Cisco NCS devices and applied event-driven automation to automatically mitigate OpenStack failures in the DCN
- Defined the observability stack for the Object Storage Load Balancers (OSS), designing alert ruling integration with labels and annotations for precise NOC signal routing
- Created an orchestration framework to operate the load balancer fleet, enabling activities such as hardening and halting real servers seamlessly and without service impact
- Technical owner for Identity and Access Management (IAM) across multi-vendor environments; designed and govern end-to-end AAA frameworks using Red Hat IDM, TACACS+, and RADIUS with Vendor-Specific Attributes

- Led UAT for 4.8 Tbps Global Server Load Balancer (GSLB) supporting large-scale Object Storage for AI data pipelines
- Applied NIST Cybersecurity Framework secure-by-design principles across all network architecture, deployment, and operational phases
- Participated in the first G42 Agentathon 2026, building agentic AI solutions on enterprise-grade orchestration frameworks

Network Architect — IP/MPLS & Data Center Fabric

Nokia · Amadora, Portugal · Apr 2019 – Nov 2024

Architecture and design consultation across Data Center Fabric, lossless AI/ML Ethernet fabrics, Network Automation, and IP/MPLS Core for global enterprise and service provider clients.

- Responsible for the Smart Grid account portfolio, driving sales of 6,000+ routers and generating more than \$6M in revenue for six consecutive years
- One of Nokia's prime specialists for lossless Ethernet AI fabrics, working hands-on with RoCEv2, ECN, DCQCN, and PFC congestion management
- Contributed to Data Center Fabric Blueprint testing new features (EVPN IP Aliasing, Event Handler, NetOps Development Kit) using Test Automation and IaC for lab operations
- Pioneered Network Automation and Infrastructure-as-Code practices within Nokia SBU, reducing manual configuration time across migration windows for multi-vendor clients
- Supported global fabric and automation initiatives including CNV (Cloud Network Verification), Secure ZTP, and DTaaS (Digital Twin as a Service)
- Delivered customized IP/MPLS network solutions for Energy, Rail, Oil, and critical infrastructure sectors — Network Core, Mobile Backhauling, EPC Infrastructure, residential services, and business VPNs
- Contributed to advanced DC Fabric and quantum-safe AnySec demonstrations — presented at MPLS SD & AI Net World 2024 — and co-organized the 1st Europe ENT DCF Partners Hackathon
- Built a Tier-3 fabric streaming-telemetry stack (Nokia SR Linux + SR OS), presented at international conferences worldwide — github.com/mairp/srl-sros-telemetry-lab
- Mentored master's degree students at IST Lisbon University on advanced networking (SRLinux, FSS, Kubernetes) supporting dissertation development

Network Consulting Engineer

Layer2 Consulting LLC (Cisco Contractor) · Honduras · Mar 2018 – Apr 2019

- Supported Cisco Advanced Services Team delivering complex solutions for enterprise clients across LATAM; led highly complex upgrade and migration activities across multiple Cisco platforms
- Built simulated networks in test labs to validate new solutions before production; reduced downtime through proactive infrastructure monitoring

Network & Security Infrastructure Specialist

S&H Support (Citi Bank Contractor) · San Salvador · Feb 2016 – Feb 2018

- Designed and implemented network and security solutions across LATAM, Caribbean, and Brazil for Citi Bank covering IP Routing Core/Aggregation/Access, Wireless, VOIP, B2B connectivity, NAT, and Firewall
- Led LATAM/Brazil divestiture infrastructure separation procedure — awarded by senior management for delivering ahead of schedule

Telecommunications Engineer

Smart Collections (Tigo Contractor) · San Salvador · Mar 2014 – Feb 2016

- Planned and implemented unified service provider networks across IP-MPLS, CORE, IPRAN, HFC, SONET/SDH, and DWDM in multivendor environments (Alcatel, Juniper, Huawei, Cisco)
- Led hierarchical VPN and IGP restructuring for All-IP MPLS mobile backhaul; implemented L2VPN, L3VPN, VPLS, VLL

CERTIFICATIONS & CREDENTIALS

ACTIVE

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| ◆ CCIE — Cisco Certified Internetwork Expert 2019 | ◆ Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA) 2019 |
| ◆ NVIDIA-Certified Associate: AI Infrastructure & Operations 2025 | ◆ Isovalent 20x Lab Champion (eBPF / Cilium) |
| ◆ Anthropic Academy — Claude with the Anthropic API 2026 | ◆ Cisco Certified DevNet Professional 2022 |

- ◆ CCNP Data Center 2025
- ◆ Cisco DevNet Specialist — Core 2022
- ◆ JNCIA-Junos — Juniper Networks 2015
- ◆ Cisco Specialist — Service Provider Core 2018
- ◆ Cisco Specialist — Enterprise Adv. Infrastructure Impl. 2013
- ◆ Nokia Data Center Fabric Professional 2021
- ◆ CCNP Enterprise 2015
- ◆ Cisco Certified DevNet Associate 2020
- ◆ Cisco Specialist — Enterprise Core 2015

IN PROGRESS — 2026/2027

- ◆ CCIE Automation Architect (Exam: August 2026)
- ◆ ISO/IEC 42001 Lead Implementer (Expected 2026)
- ◆ Claude Certified Architect — Foundations (Expected 2027)

NVIDIA AI / HPC FABRIC TRAINING — INFINIBAND · RDMA · UFM

- ◆ AI Infrastructure and Operations Fundamentals
- ◆ Data Center Management Made Easy with NVIDIA UFM
- ◆ RDMA over Converged Ethernet (RoCE) from A to Z
- ◆ InfiniBand Network Administration
- ◆ InfiniBand Professional

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Engineering — Electrical Engineering

Central American University 'José Simeón Cañas' · San Salvador · 2009

AWARDS & COMMUNITY

- Participant — 1st G42 Agentathon 2026 (agentic AI innovation challenge)
- Published Author — Springer Nature, Journal of Cloud Computing (2025) & IEEE Xplore (2026)
- Isovalent 20× Lab Champion — eBPF/Cilium advanced networking community recognition
- 1st Place — IEEE Championship: Wireless Control of Mini Cars (2007)
- Speaker — MPLS SD & AI Net World 2024 (quantum-safe AnySec demonstration)
- Presented Tier-3 fabric streaming-telemetry stack (SR Linux + SR OS) at international conferences — github.com/mairp/srl-sros-telemetry-lab
- SRExperts Contributor — Nokia advanced DC Fabric demonstrations
- Co-organizer — 1st Europe ENT DCF Partners Hackathon
- Academic Mentor — IST Lisbon master's students (SRLinux, FSS, Kubernetes)

LANGUAGES

English (Professional) **Spanish** (Native) **Portuguese** (Professional)

Full portfolio: mairp.ai — **AIOps Architect** · Abu Dhabi, UAE · References available upon request